

ASEAN

ASEAN COMMITTEE ON CONSUMER PROTECTION IS PROGRESSING FORWARD WITH SOLUTIONS AT A STEADY PACE

Tuesday, June 23, 2026 at 2.30 p.m.

In the ASEAN Committee on Consumer Protection (ACCP) Conference, the council has been split into two blocs. While one bloc supports the Minister of Myanmar's unspecified document and the other supports the Minister of Thailand's unspecified document. The question still remains on how will the council come to a consensus.



Nhân Dân reporter, Wang Sijia engaging with the Minister of Myanmar and the Minister of Cambodia in a four minute interview

With the limited information on the unspecified document, Nhân Dân has formally requested for the two Ministers of Myanmar and Cambodia for an interview and they have kindly agreed on sharing about the unspecified document that she is contributing to.

The Minister of Myanmar has commented that: “Our unspecified document is about minimum standards because ASEAN is a country where many different countries have a myriad of economic domains and regulation. Therefore, taking these into consideration, we have steered our content in this direction.”

Nhân Dân was very impressed by the depth of the content in the unspecified document, commenting afterwards that the Minister of the Socialist Republic of Vietnam would give the unspecified document her vote for. The rest was officially classified and will not be released until further updates from the ACCP Council.

Since none of the unspecified documents have been approved by the General-Directors of the ASEAN Committee on Consumer Protection, the latest information of the two blocs Nhân Dân had access to were the Memorandum of Understandings (MoUs) with multiple countries writing these.

The Kingdom of Cambodia, along with The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland as sponsors, and Kingdom of Myanmar as a signatory, have produced a MoU that sets out the terms and understanding between the Kingdom of Cambodia and the United Kingdom in the implementation of efforts to ensure adequate consumer protections, to prevent financial distress among all citizens.

These Ministers have introduced a Financial Literacy Programme that is dedicated to educating consumers and assists in the implementation of accessible financial literacy programmes across ASEAN states which includes, but is not limited to standardised Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) warning systems and educational toolkits.

The Financial Literacy Programme also encourages the implementation of assessments and courses where participation is highly recommended for borrowers, especially for those under 35 years of age. Participants would be able to assess their awareness on responsible lending practices too.

This MoU aligns greatly with Viet Nam’s national consumer protection laws. Trinh Anh Tuan, Chairman of the National Competition Commission shared focuses on strengthening enforcement capacity for consumer protection agencies, enhancing cooperation on product

safety, improving the effectiveness of the Online Dispute Resolution (ODR) network, and promoting the participation of social organisations in consumer protection efforts¹.

The Socialist Republic of Viet Nam applauds these Ministers for working with Viet Nam's beliefs in mind. Having these Ministers assisting Viet Nam in reaching goals, Viet Nam will stand by this MoU deeply.

Even though the Minister of Vietnam has not been voicing solutions, we can see that the Minister is listening attentively to current proposals in these unspecified documents on the floor and noting down loopholes of certain frameworks from what we saw was the numerous notes on her table.

The Minister of Vietnam will continue to make her quiet contributions towards the ACCP Committee and steer the council in the right direction to resolve Vietnam's public issues with current policies regarding consumer rights and protection.

The ASEAN Committee of Consumer Protection has made great progress. Now, Ministers are striving towards combining solutions together and making sure stances are aligned with each clause in the unspecified document. However, the question still remains on will the Committee come to a consensus. The Minister of Vietnam will continuously make her contributions to the council and push for Vietnam's national interest and build on further into the Comprehensive Agreements Vietnam had made with the ASEAN members.

¹ Web Portal Ministry of Industry and Trade. "Vietnam to Lead ASEAN Consumer Protection Efforts as Chair of ASEAN Committee on Consumer Protection in 2026." moit.gov.vn, May 30, 2026.
<https://moit.gov.vn/en/news/vietnam-to-lead-asean-consumer-protection-efforts-as-chair-of-asean-committee-on-consumer-protection-in-2026.html>.